

Trophy

Mullin Seals A Historic Double

No player had ever left a TEG with both prizes until Boavista's final round settled it.

David Mullin completed the TEG 2 Trophy and Green Jacket double at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort. Nobody had managed it before.

Mullin was already sitting on the Jacket lead. Round 3 handed him the Trophy as well. He took the outright lead at the third, a par-5, where a bogey was enough to lift him to the top of the Net VP standings. That is worth pausing on. A bogey was enough to overturn Jon Baker's overnight advantage.

By the close of the round he led the Trophy by seven. Baker's three-shot cushion had simply ceased to exist. The Jacket lead, meanwhile, stretched from eight to eleven.

The round also marked a personal high point at the course. An 89, his best gross score there across five visits through this TEG. That is ten strokes better than his previous visit and a new course best for him this TEG. With both prizes in hand, his position looked close to unassailable heading into the closing rounds.

At a Glance

Trophy Winner
David Mullin

Green Jacket
David Mullin

Wooden Spoon
Henry Meller

Round Net VP

DM -2 | HM +2 | SN +3 | GW +6 | JB +8

Round Gross

DM +18 | HM +20 | SN +21 | GW +34 | JB +36

After R3 • Trophy

DM +6 | JB +13 | SN +23 | GW +27 | HM +39

After R3 • Green Jacket

DM +66 | SN +77 | HM +93 | JB +97 | GW +111

David Mullin

Mullin Rewrites The Boavista Record Book

Two rounds earlier David Mullin had been the tournament's most beatable leader; on the Algarve's Atlantic links he produced the best round anyone has played.

David Mullin produced the best round recorded in TEG history on Boavista's third round. A net -2, which also stands as the best gross round ever posted. It was an 18-over-par 89. Both of those things are true at once, and the second one tells you rather a lot about this company.

It was a new course record for Boavista, beating the previous mark of 91 set across ten prior visits. It improved Mullin's own best on the course by two strokes.

The leaderboard rearranged itself accordingly. Mullin arrived at Boavista second in the TEG Trophy, three behind Jon Baker. He left it seven clear at the top, having swung from worst to first among the field of five. He held the Green Jacket lead throughout and extended it to eleven. That is the double, Mullin's first, with no prior instances recorded in TEG history.

The context makes it stranger still. In round two Mullin had shot an 8, one of the worst scores of

the tournament. He then posted a -2 the very next day. A swing of ten shots, offered without explanation and requiring no apology. Henry Meller, for his part, remained anchored to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon standings, now twelve back from safety.

Wooden Spoon

Meller's Masterclass Comes Too Late

A brilliant final round proved the cruellest kind of consolation.

Henry Meller produced the round of his tournament at Boavista Golf & Spa Resort on Monday. It changed nothing whatsoever.

His gross 20 was the second-best gross round recorded in TEG history to date. It arrived directly after a miserable Round 2 that had left him near the bottom of the field. The swing from a 13 to a 2 stands as one of the sharpest turnarounds of the tournament. Somewhere in the middle of it he went two holes without dropping a shot, birdieing the par-4 5th and then parring the 6th. In the context of his week, this was a golden age.

It was also a course personal best for Meller at Boavista, on his fifth visit to the venue, eleven strokes better than his previous visit there. None of it moved him off the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race. He was the laggard before the round and the laggard after it. The gap to safety narrowed from 16 to 12. That is the kind of progress that gets a man precisely nowhere.

Jon Baker

Five Holes That Cost The Trophy

The overnight leader's round came apart before the turn, and never recovered.

Jon Baker began the third round holding the Trophy lead by three shots. The start he made at Boavista put the race beyond him.

He opened with a double bogey at the 1st. He added another double at the 2nd. He then ran up an 8 at the par-5 3rd. A triple bogey followed at the par-3 4th, one of the hardest holes on the course. A double bogey at the par-4 5th completed the sequence. Five holes, not one net par, 12 gross shots gone.

The damage did not end there. On the back nine he posted a quadruple bogey 8 at the par-4 15th. Between the two collapses the round unravelled far enough to hand the initiative to David Mullin, who took over the Trophy lead. Baker's three-shot advantage going into the day was a seven-shot deficit by the close of play. He arrived as the leader and left as the exhibit.

Records & Personal Bests

Notable achievements: TEG 2, Round 3

Course Records

— David Mullin's 89 at Boavista — a new course record, beating 91; 10 earlier rounds there